SAINT MICHAEL COLLEGE OF CARAGA

CHALLENGES FACED BY NON-UNIFORMED PERSONNEL IN POLICE STATIONS: A PHENOMENOLOGICAL STUDY

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By

MICHAEL V. BELANESO
DON IVERSON L. BATULAN
NERLITH ANNE A. BONES
FRANCIS RUTHER Q. JAYOMA
RONALD B. NAKILA
JEANIE E. REBOSADA

ADVISER: REILVEN T. TELEN, MSCRIM (CAR)

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CHAPTER 1

THE PROBLEM AND ITS SCOPE

1.1 Background of the Study

The Philippine National Police (PNP) was the Philippines' primary law enforcement agency. The Philippine National Police consists of uniformed and non-uniformed Personnel stationed at various police stations. Non-uniformed Personnel provide critical technical and support capabilities, freeing uniformed Personnel to focus on enforcing the law. Non-uniformed or civilian Personnel may provide administrative, technical, and support services such as reception, finance, human resources, legal help, information technology, communications, and other activities that support the police service's fundamental functions (Conor et al., 2018).

Police stations worldwide hire many non-uniformed personnel. They performed administrative, clerical, and support tasks vital for operation. According to Trullinger (2016), "civilians who now complete these tasks do so for less compensation and fewer benefits while working more days per year, with less equipment and less training" (p. 45). For example, in Canada, the United States, and the United Kingdom, hiring non-uniformed personnel has increased as rapidly as hiring uniformed personnel (Lentz et al., 2020). Although non-uniformed Personnel play an important role in police operations, they face workplace issues that differ from or are comparable to those faced by uniformed Personnel. Despite its expansion, non-uniform Personnel experienced obstacles related to police culture, employment circumstances, and training (Mousseau et al., 2025).

In the Philippine studies, Lazaro et al. (2023) found that non-uniformed Personnel were moderately satisfied with work-related domains such as supervision, recognition, and communication, but unsatisfied with salary and benefits, indicating that organizational support and recognition are critical to overall job gratification. However, these challenges affect their job performance in police stations. Romero, J. R. (2024) noted job gratification among non-uniformed personnel according to their employment role, educational attainment, and length of service. Laraga et al. (2025) also stated that fostering collaboration in the workplace renders organizational resilience and boosts personnel morale, which leads to greater job satisfaction and retention. However, none of these studies addresses the evolving challenges over time and the role of organizational interventions, leaving a gap that needs to be studied.

The study intends to comprehend and investigate the variables affecting mental health and to offer a proactive strategy for addressing the difficulties faced by NUPs in police stations to guarantee adequate community service. Using a qualitative approach, this research aims to enable non-uniformed Personnel a voice and provide a deeper understanding of how NUPs experience, perceive, and interpret their workplace environment. The results of this study could help police organizations make better decisions about policy, interventions, management, and training for their employees. These insights can help make law enforcement agencies' workplaces more welcoming and supportive.

This phenomenological study will explore the challenges faced by non-uniformed Personnel in police stations, emphasizing challenges including work overload, limited career advancement, safety concerns, and burnout at the workplace. Although International and Philippine studies recognized the increasing significance of non-uniformed Personnel in law enforcement, most of the recent studies focus

dominantly on uniformed personnel and use quantitative methods, leaving a gap in understanding the lived experiences of non-uniformed Personnel.

1.2 Theoretical Framework

The study is anchored on the Transactional Theory of Stress and Coping by Richard Lazarus and Susan Folkman (1984), while Moustakas' Transcendental Phenomenology (1994) serves as the core methodological foundation for exploring the lived experiences of non-uniformed Personnel in police stations. These frameworks explain the experiences of non-uniformed personnel regarding workplace stress and facilitate a deeper and understandable comprehension of their lived experiences.

The Transactional Theory of Stress and Coping provides a dynamic framework for comprehending the transformation of challenges into stressors. According to Lazarus and Folkman (1984), stress is a process that involves cognitive appraisals, first judging whether a situation is threatening or challenging, and then evaluating the resources available to cope with it. Biggs (2017) emphasizes the importance of primary and secondary appraisals, showing how coping resources help individuals manage workplace stress. Dillard (2019) explains that cognitive appraisals and coping strategies are highly associated with stress outcomes connected to occupational demands.

This theory remains fundamental in modern research, as it explains how people understand stress and choose coping behaviors in different environments, including the workplace (Dillard, 2019; Estrada, 2020; Faryabi, 2022). Spătaru (2024) highlights the connections among appraisals, coping strategies, and mental well-being, underscoring the theory's importance for understanding stress management over

time. Wu et al. (2025) add that emotional coping and social support significantly shape how individuals perceive stress. These findings support the theory's relevance and its value in understanding the challenges faced by non-uniformed Personnel at police stations.

Moustakas' Transcendental Phenomenology provides the methodological foundation for the study. This approach focuses on describing how individuals experience challenges by using bracketing or epoché, which involves setting aside personal biases to understand experiences as they truly are. Moustakas (1994) explains epoché as deliberately identifying and suspending one's natural assumptions to allow the researcher to hear participants' genuine voices without outside influence (Moustakas, 1994; van Manen, 2016). This framework helps the study capture not only the experiences of non-uniformed personnel but also the more profound meanings behind their realities in the law enforcement environment (Moustakas, 1994; Cresswell & Poth, 2018).

The integration of the Transactional Theory of Stress and Coping with Moustakas' Transcendental Phenomenology creates a comprehensive approach for examining the work challenges of non-uniformed police personnel. Neubauer et al. (2019) emphasize that bracketing reveals people's subjective realities and highlights phenomenology's strength in exploring lived experiences. Dillard (2019) uses the Transactional Theory to show how coping strategies and cognitive appraisals shape stress outcomes, while Estrada (2020) demonstrates how these processes operate specifically in law enforcement settings. Moran et al. (2023) further confirm phenomenology's ability to uncover more profound meanings behind workplace issues such as unclear roles and interpersonal tensions. Meanwhile, Wu et al. (2025) show how the theory consistently identifies effective coping strategies in high-stress work environments.

1.3 Review of Related Literature

The study presents related literature and studies that will support and strengthen the importance of the current research. This review emphasizes the requirement that non-uniformed personnel thoroughly understand the study.

Non-Uniformed Personnel and Civilianization in Evolving Policing

Globally, the civilianization of policing has emerged as a strategy to improve efficiency, reduce costs, and bring specialized skills into police organizations. The primary impetus for civilianization is claimed to be a concern for greater cost-effectiveness and efficiency in the face of fiscal constraints (Forst, 2000; Ruddell & Jones, 2014; Kiedrowskie et al., 2017). The growth of non-uniformed personnel helps meet the growing needs of law enforcement, cut costs, and support community-based programs (Trullinger, 2017). Civilianization refers to assigning non-uniformed Personnel to perform police tasks that do not require a sworn officer's authority or training (Griffiths et al., 2006; Conor et al., 2018). It can also help address staffing shortages and improve the delivery of police services (Police Forum, 2024, p. 18). Furthermore, “civilian personnel bring diverse skills and perspectives that strengthen police work” (Alderden & Skogan, 2014; Kiedrowski et al., 2019; Rice, 2020; Poikela et al., 2025, p. 5).

In the Philippines, the Philippine National Police (PNP) employs NUPs who handle administrative and technical tasks. Under R.A. 8551, Sec. 13, non-uniformed personnel serve in roles that are technical, administrative, clerical, or menial in nature. However, despite legal support such as R.A. 6975, their contributions often receive limited recognition. So, both uniformed and non-uniformed personnel should

work together to help the PNP reach its goal of serving and protecting (Romero, 2023). The Philippine National Police (PNP), as a law enforcement agency, "mandates to strengthen crime prevention efforts and crime solution measures" (Racoma et al., 2025, p. 2).

According to Senate Bill No. 2594 (2015), the civilian workforce in the PNP plays an important role and deserves protections and benefits similar to those given to uniformed personnel. The rise of civilianization ensures that law enforcement agencies have sufficient resources and support to maintain public safety and security in the Philippines (Jones, 2019; Laraga et al., 2025). Non-uniformed Personnel also contribute to digitalization and improved police operations, including the implementation of the Next Generation Investigation Solutions (NGIS) system (Racoma et al., 2025).

Police Organization Inclusion and Workplace Environment

A common issue in police organizations worldwide is the gap between uniformed and non-uniformed employees. Many studies show that civilian staff often feel less included in police departments, where uniforms, traditions, and rank powerfully shape culture and hierarchy. As Kiedrowskie et al. (2017) note, uniforms and rank insignia symbolize seniority and status, unintentionally creating divisions between sworn officers and civilian personnel. Civilians often fill roles previously held by sworn officers, including operational support (e.g., analysts, dispatchers) and administrative functions (Kiedrowskie et al., 2017, p. 9). Although civilianization offers many advantages, challenges remain—such as low morale, poor working conditions, high turnover, and a greater likelihood of resignations among non-uniformed staff due to unequal treatment (Xu & Ji, 2018).

To be effective, police stations need clear job descriptions, fair hiring practices, and a supportive work environment that values people who don't wear uniforms (Linklater, 2022). But non-uniformed

workers often don't know what their jobs are, don't receive enough help from their bosses, and don't obtain enough mental health support, which can make them stressed and unhappy with their jobs (Madhavi & Bandaru, 2023). Additionally, structural and cultural obstacles persist in obstructing the integration and professional advancement of civilian personnel (Police Forum, 2024).

In the Philippine setting, organizational support significantly affects job satisfaction for both uniformed and non-uniformed staff. Bag-ao et al. (2024) emphasize that recognition and opportunities for professional growth improve morale and strengthen employees' sense of belonging. Despite this, hierarchical culture, limited inclusive policies, and restricted avenues for participation continue to hinder full inclusion within the PNP (Laraga et al., 2025).

The PNP's work culture reflects a strong hierarchy that reinforces status differences between senior and junior Personnel, as well as between uniformed and non-uniformed staff, often leaving non-uniformed employees feeling marginalized (Ombos et al., 2023). Although policies supporting NUPs exist, challenges remain in implementing them at all levels (Jambora & Garcia, 2023). Recent studies call for reforms that promote inclusion through diversity training, open communication, and career development for non-uniformed Personnel. According to Oliva (2024), workplace factors such as gender, diversity, and work ethic greatly influence employee well-being and engagement. These efforts are essential to creating an inclusive, respectful, and motivating work environment for all Personnel, including civilians (Liem & Razon, 2024).

Occupational Stress and Mental Health Challenges

Stress and mental health concerns have increasingly become important issues and challenges for non-uniformed Personnel in policing. Foreign studies indicate that non-uniformed personnel (NUPs)

experience psychological pressure due to heavy workload, constant deadlines, and limited coping mechanisms. Carleton et al. (2018), for example, found that civilian employees were more likely than uniformed Personnel to show symptoms of anxiety and depression. Furthermore, Ravalier et al. (2020) report that workers experiencing high job strain were more prone to developing depressive symptoms. Pappa et al. (2021) report that elevated levels of emotional exhaustion and psychological distress are due to prolonged work hours and exposure to traumatic events. Yamamoto et al. (2021) identified long working hours and poor work-life balance as significant predictors of anxiety and depressive disorders among employees.

Recent studies emphasize the importance of organizational support in reducing psychological distress. Harvey et al. (2020) found that mental health programs helped reduce psychological distress among employees. Leka et al. (2021) also highlighted that supportive leadership, workload management, and employee engagement could lessen burnout and improve job satisfaction. Additionally, practical interventions like flexible scheduling and access to counseling services have been shown to improve mental well-being and reduce sick leave (Agarwal et al., 2022).

In the Philippines, non-uniformed Personnel report high levels of anxiety, insomnia, and emotional exhaustion due to tight deadlines and constant pressure to deliver reports. Hernandez et al. (2023) noted that some employees internalize their stress because they fear being judged or misunderstood. Local studies also point to recurring issues such as role overload, sleep problems, and emotional fatigue among non-uniformed personnel handling daily administrative responsibilities (Lazaro et al., 2022; Romero et al., 2024). De Leon (2025) explained that when organizational expectations are not matched with mental health support, employees are more likely to experience prolonged stress and job dissatisfaction.

According to PNP MC No. 115 (2021), stress and mental health challenges can affect individuals within the Philippine National Police (PNP) regardless of rank or position and, when unmanaged, may result in psychological, physical, and emotional distress or worsen pre-existing mental health conditions. Despite this, some challenges remain. Cardenas and Nabe (2024) found that problems, including unclear promotion pathways, limited resources, and a sense of undervalued contributions, contribute to stress and low morale among NUPs. Papagayo (2024) also noted that numerous non-uniformed personnel were reluctant to seek help due to stigma and confidentiality concerns..

Police officers and civilian staff who support law enforcement operations recognize the importance of mental health programs. These programs help employees cope with work-related stress, prevent burnout, and address emotional difficulties (Daniel, 2023; Oglimen & Panday, 2025). However, we still need to strengthen access and ensure that these services cater to both uniformed and non-uniformed personnel.

Career Development and Non-uniform Personnel Safety

Limited opportunities for career advancement and security among non-uniformed personnel are a significant global issue. Numerous agencies offer restricted promotional opportunities or professional training programs for civilians, exacerbating perceptions of stagnation (Lurigio & Skogan, 2018). Tufano (2018) analyzes the shifts in role identity from police responsibilities to civilian life, while Chalfin (2020) addresses the police workforce and its impact on civilian workforce integration, emphasizing the importance of career adaptability. Whelan and Harkin (2021) also describe how civilian integration affects how well an organization is accepted and how well a person's career progresses. McMahon (2022) noted

the motivating factors influencing career choices and job satisfaction among undergraduates in law enforcement, offering recommendations for recruitment and retention strategies.

Rahman and Ismail (2024) highlight the challenges of striking a balance between career growth and workplace safety while also advocating for gender-sensitive policies that foster inclusivity and equitable recognition. Poikela et al. (2024) revealed that structural barriers to career mobility and challenges in gaining legitimacy within police organizations exist. Octavio (2025) emphasized the importance of training programs and professional development to enhance skill sets, improve job performance, and support career progression among non-uniformed Personnel. Allowing non-uniformed personnel to focus effectively requires identifying the critical role of organizational support and safety measures in fostering a secure work environment (Singh et al., 2025).

Senate Bill No. 2375 (2021) states that "the importance of recognizing and cognizing the invaluable role of non-uniformed personnel (NUPs) in providing administrative and other support services that allow the former to perform their duties and responsibilities" (p. 1). Laraga et al. (2025) conclude that "by implementing initiatives aimed at promoting work-life balance, providing access to counseling services, and fostering a supportive work culture, the PNP can create a healthier and more productive workforce" (p. 6). Racoma et al. (2025) noted that non-uniformed personnel still have a challenging time keeping that balance because their jobs are getting harder, and they are always expected to be productive.

According to Lazaro (2023), the safety of NUP was occasionally compromised by uncontrollable factors, such as non-uniformed individuals being misidentified as uniformed troops by state radicals, potentially rendering them targets for attacks. Robredo and Reyes (2023) emphasize that crisis management skills in areas such as negotiation, bomb threats, and VAWC responses enhance the safety

and efficiency of police officers, including non-uniformed Personnel who play a significant support role. Torres et al. (2024) found that coping skills and emotional intelligence strengthen resilience and reduce vulnerability to stress in police work.

Stress and Coping Strategies

Non-uniformed personnel adopt strategies such as looking for social support, maintaining work–life balance, and developing emotional resilience. Active engagement in prosocial behaviors and emotional support networks was a key factor in sustaining mental health during a prolonged period of stress, highlighting the role of community and relational resources in promoting resilience (Zhuang et al., 2023). Vincze et al. (2024) noted that psychological resilience and effective coping are crucial for managing stress in high-pressure situations distinct to policing. Adaptive coping mechanisms like confrontation, social support, and mental preparation are vital to manage job-related trauma (Dietrich et al., 2024). Nonetheless, mental health stigma inhibits non-uniformed personnel from obtaining assistance, underscoring the necessity to cultivate supportive organizational cultures (Haugen et al., 2024).

Queirós et al. (2020) demonstrate that officers typically report a mix of problem, emotion, and avoidant strategies. Spaan et al. (2023) found that peer support among forensic mental health workers is practical only when built on confidentiality and mutual trust. Zhou et al. (2024) similarly demonstrate that active coping and cognitive reframing are associated with reduced occupational burnout, whereas avoidant coping is linked to an increased symptom burden. Modula (2024) noted that valuing stoicism and emotional control hinders help-seeking, leading officers to rely mainly on peer support.



1.4 Objectives of the Study

General Objectives

The study aims to analyze and describe the lived experiences, perceptions, and challenges faced by non-uniformed personnel in police stations, aiming to gain a deeper understanding of their roles, difficulties, and contributions within the law enforcement setting.

Specific Objectives

1. To identify the challenges faced by non-uniformed personnel with their colleagues and career opportunities in their work.
2. To explore the emotional and psychological impacts of these challenges.
3. To understand how these challenges affect their job performance and professional relationships within the police station.
4. To examine the coping strategies used by non-uniformed personnel to manage work-related stress and difficulties.

1.5 Scope and Limitations

The study focuses on exploring the lived experience of non-uniformed personnel currently working at any police station within the Province of Agusan del Norte and the challenges they face. The study will utilize a phenomenological approach to obtain subjective perspectives and significances that these non-uniformed personnel attribute to their experiences within the police station. The study

primarily examines the organizational, interpersonal, and psychosocial challenges they faced and the coping strategies they used.

This study only includes non-uniformed Personnel in active police stations as participants. The study's sample will be small and purposively selected, which may not reflect the full diversity of experience and perspectives among non-uniformed Personnel across various police stations.

1.6 Definition of Terms

Challenges - refers to concerns or trials they faced daily by non-uniformed Personnel in police stations.

Coping Strategies—plans, methods, and strategies to adapt to specific challenges encountered.

Civilianization – uses of civilian in law enforcement or in policing.

Law Enforcement—served as the frontline agencies in upholding the law.

Non-Uniformed Personnel—refers to a civilian employee or civilian staff member who does not hold a uniformed status in the police stations.

The Philippine National Police is an agency that serves as the frontline of law enforcement in the Philippines, upholding crime prevention and maintaining peace and order.

Stress is a feeling of discomfort—emotional, physical, and psychological—that leads to depression, which may be challenging to face.

Uniformed Personnel - refers to Personnel who hold or wear uniforms in police stations.

CHAPTER 2

METHODOLOGY

This chapter will explain the research setting, the participants who will be answering questions, and the sampling methods that will be used to ensure the study's results are valid and accurately reflect the situation. It also discusses the plan for analyzing the data, which lists the steps that will be taken to make sense of the information that was collected in line with the study's goals. Finally, this chapter stresses how important it is to follow strict ethical rules during the research process to protect everyone's privacy, honesty, and respect.

2.1 Research Design

A qualitative phenomenological research method will be used to look into and understand the problems that non-uniformed Personnel (NUPs) face in a police station. This design is based on how people evaluate and interpret their daily work experiences, particularly regarding company culture, hierarchy, and administrative tasks. McLeod (2024) asserts that a phenomenological study aims to delve into the essence of life.

The researcher will choose non-uniformed personnel from different stations who have worked in administrative, clerical, or technical jobs to take part. Purposive sampling will be used to ensure that everyone who participates has experience and information relevant to the study. The main way that data will be gathered is through in-depth, semi-structured interviews, which will allow subjects to talk freely about their thoughts and feelings about their daily work experiences. All conversations will be recorded,

transcribed accurately, and analyzed using thematic analysis to identify patterns, meanings, and central themes that reveal what they all have in common.

2.2 Research Locale

The study will be conducted in selected police stations across Agusan del Norte in the Caraga region of Mindanao. These locations offer diverse settings that help the researcher understand the experiences of non-uniformed personnel working in law enforcement. The chosen police stations serve as the main focus of the study because they provide potential respondents for it.

Conducting the study in this location allows the researcher to observe and understand the real-life challenges, experiences, and perspectives of non-uniformed personnel in their actual work environment. These police stations provide access to individuals who have firsthand knowledge of how the workplace and organizational systems operate. Focusing on police stations in Agusan del Norte ensures that the findings are culturally grounded, contextually relevant, and reflective of the unique organizational and community setting in which these non-uniformed personnel work.

2.3 Research Respondent

Respondents of the study were non-uniformed personnel who worked in certain police stations. These are professionals who work in police stations and help them run every day. They include administrative staff, clerks, records officers, IT support staff, financial or supply officers, and other civilian employees who do not wear uniforms but do help with daily tasks. Because they confront these problems every day at the police station, they were chosen as the best people to study the phenomenon under investigation.

2.4 Research Instrument

A qualitative, in-depth, semi-structured interview was the primary tool we used for this study. The researcher selected this instrument as it facilitates the acquisition of comprehensive and pertinent narratives from participants, reflecting their experiences and perspectives regarding the subject under investigation. The first part was about collecting responder profiles provided by the interviewees at the start of the session. Details like age, gender, and background provided important information that helped correctly understand and explain participants' answers and why their answers differed.

Researchers used the semi-structured interview guide to elicit rich, detailed, and important stories that helped them better understand the study problem. The study aimed to uncover subjective meaning and personal perspectives, and they believed that conducting in-depth interviews was the most effective method. This ensured that the collected data aligned with the study's search objectives.

2.5 Data Analysis Procedure

A qualitative research method will be used to identify the difficulties non-uniformed Personnel (NUPs) face in police stations from their perspectives. The study doesn't want to find numerical values for the variable; the study is to examine subjective feelings. In-depth, semi-structured interviews were used to collect qualitative data. Participants were able to share detailed stories and thoughts about their daily work experiences, interactions with uniformed personnel, and the organization's conditions.

Purposive sampling will be used to select participants who can provide rich, important, and varied information about the challenges non-uniformed personnel face. Their input was significant for

understanding NUP's larger work at the police station and helped a lot with the study's goal of identifying the challenges of non-uniformed personnel they face.

2.6 Ethical Considerations

A. Protection of Intellectual Property Rights (IPR)

Developing new technologies, processes, or products that require patent protection is not part of the study. However, the study will provide original materials, such as recordings and interview guides, and the researcher will use them to conduct academic work by analyzing them by theme. Saint Michael College of Caraga still owns the study's image, but it is included for academic and identification reasons. Therefore, the study does not create any new brand, logo, or sign that requires trademark registration.

B. Informed Consent

Those interested in participating in the study were informed about its goal, how it would be conducted, and any potential risks or benefits. The researcher will state that participation in the study was optional and that people could withdraw at any time with no consequences. Participants were told that any information gathered would be kept secret and used only for academic purposes. Respondents gave their full consent before data collection began to ensure they understood and wanted to take part.

C. Data Privacy and Confidentiality

Interviews with participants will be used to collect their personal and sensitive information, which will be handled in accordance with the Data Privacy Act of 2012 (RA 10173). To protect privacy, all participant data will be "anonymized," meaning that any information that could be used to identify a

person will be removed. Instead, each user will receive a coded ident ifier. The data will be kept safely, and only the researcher and the study adviser will be able to access it.

D. Voluntary Participation and Freedom to Withdraw

Study participants were informed that they could leave at any time without penalty. The researcher ensured that participants were aware that their decision to participate or not would not affect their job, relationships, or standing. It all depended on their willingness and comfort level.

E. Minimization of Harm

To protect participants from physical, mental, or emotional harm, the study ensured that all interview questions were safe and non-threatening. Participants were interviewed in a private, comfortable setting and were informed that they could skip any question or stop the interview at any time. The researcher also treated everyone with respect and care, avoiding judgment throughout the data collection process. The 3Rs (Replacement, Reduction, and Refinement) did not apply because animals were not used in the study. However, the ethical principle of minimizing harm was carefully followed. Any participant who felt uncomfortable or stressed during the interview was immediately offered support and provided with information about counseling or other available institutional support services.

F. Beneficence

The study aims to contribute to academic research and benefit society by providing a clear understanding of the challenges faced by non-uniformed personnel in police stations. This will help us make better policies, set up better support systems for employees, and help the organization grow. The information gathered from this study can help organizations create better workplaces and support non-

uniformed personnel in being more productive. Participants may also request a copy of the results so they can see and understand how their input contributed to the study's findings.

G. Justice and Fair Participant Selection

Participants were chosen fairly based on clear rules about who could and couldn't take part. For example, they had to be non-uniformed personnel working in police stations. There was no bias based on age, gender, rank, race, or personal views when people from all walks of life were included. These rules made sure that everyone who met the requirements had the same chance. Problems with picking animal types were irrelevant because the study didn't use any.

H. Integrity and Accuracy of Data

The researcher used clear and consistent ways to collect and analyze the data to confirm that the results were correct and trustworthy. Interviews were done regularly, and well-known qualitative methods like coding and thematic analysis were used to look closely at the answers respondents gave. The researcher also considered and noted any potential biases, limitations, or errors that might have influenced the interpretation of the data and participants' experiences.

I. Transparency in Reporting

The researcher will freely and honestly share the study results, along with the participants' experiences and perspectives, without any lies, fabrications, or misrepresentations. All sources used in the study, even those that are protected by intellectual property rights or have already been published, will be properly mentioned and acknowledged in line with academic and moral standards. This process is to ensure that the reporting is completely truthful and open. The form's top and bottom

H. Use of Patented or Copyrighted Materials

The study required no permission from patent holders because it used no patented technologies. Any copyrighted materials used in the study, such as books, reports, or software, were properly cited and referenced, and permissions were required when needed to ensure that intellectual property rules and academic practices were followed.

K. Ethical Considerations for Animal and Human Trials

Participants were fully informed of the research's purpose, procedures, potential risks, and benefits before providing their voluntary consent, ensuring that their participation was ethical and well-informed. Moral principles, including confidentiality, privacy, and the right to withdraw at any time, were strictly upheld throughout the research. No animals were used in this study, so ethical clearance for animal trials and adherence to humane treatment standards were unnecessary.

L. Responsible Use of AI and Related Technologies

AI tools will only be used smartly to help people study. ChatGPT helps to organize the literature review and summarize the initial results, but it will not generate new data. Grammarly will check spelling and readability, while QuillBot will rewrite for clarity. The researcher will carefully check, edit, and review all AI-generated results to ensure their accuracy and adherence to academic standards.

M. Clearance for Ethics and Approval from the Institution

The researcher sought permission from the Ethics Review Board of Saint Michael College of Caraga before commencing the study. This step makes sure that the study will obey the right rules

for the people who take part. Before collecting data, permission should be sought to confirm that the study follows university rules and protects privacy, informed consent, and participants' choice to take part. The researchers will be careful, respectful, and honest with all the information they collect throughout the process.